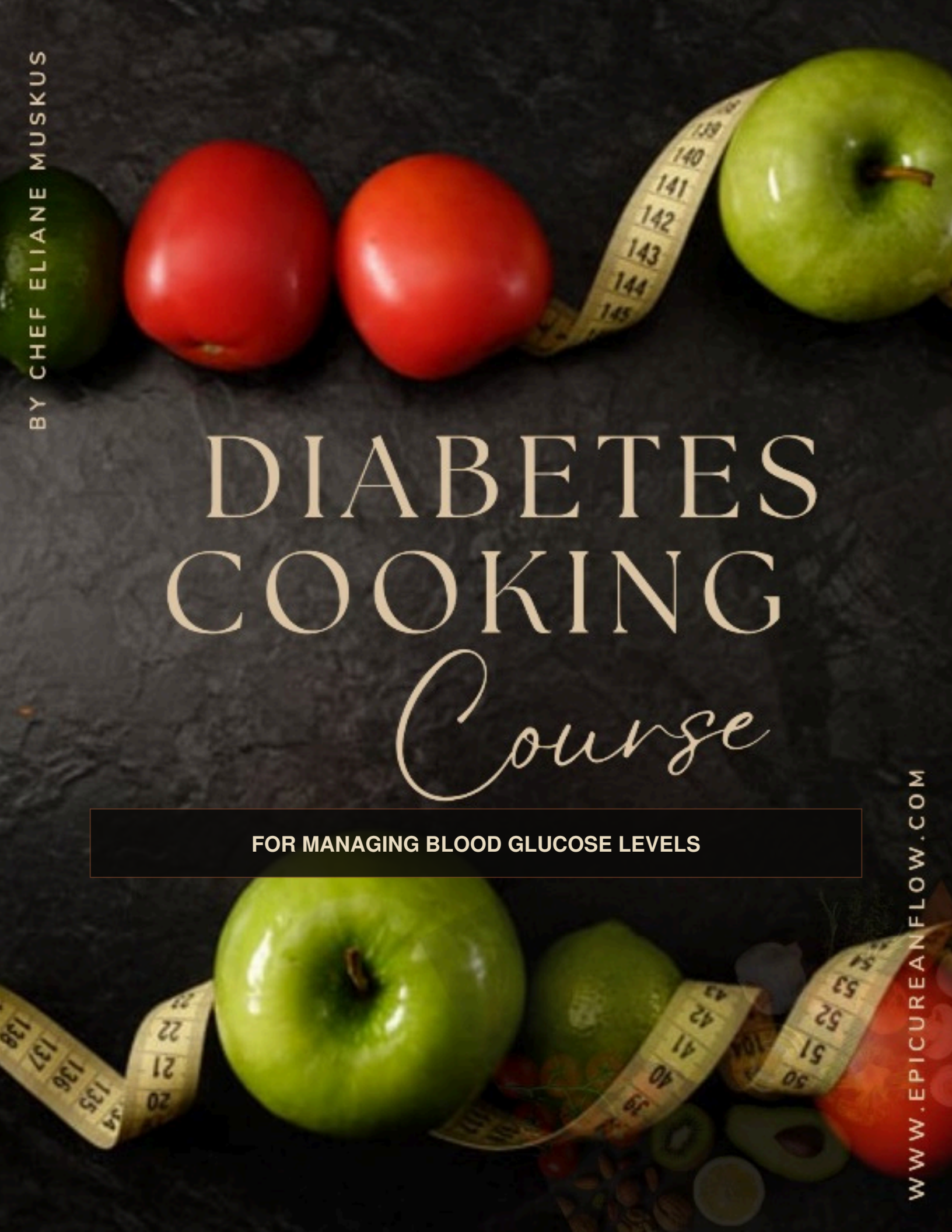

BY CHEF ELIANE MUSKUS
DIABETES
COOKING
Course
FOR MANAGING BLOOD GLUCOSE LEVELS
WWW.EPICUREANFLOW.COM

Disclaimer

This eBook is intended for informational and educational purposes only. The recipes, tips, and suggestions provided are based on the author’s professional experience and personal preferences. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy, readers are encouraged to use their own judgment and consult with healthcare professionals when necessary, particularly in the context of dietary restrictions or medical conditions such as diabetes.

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For permissions or inquiries, please contact:
📩 info@epicureanflow.com
🌐 www.epicureanflow.com

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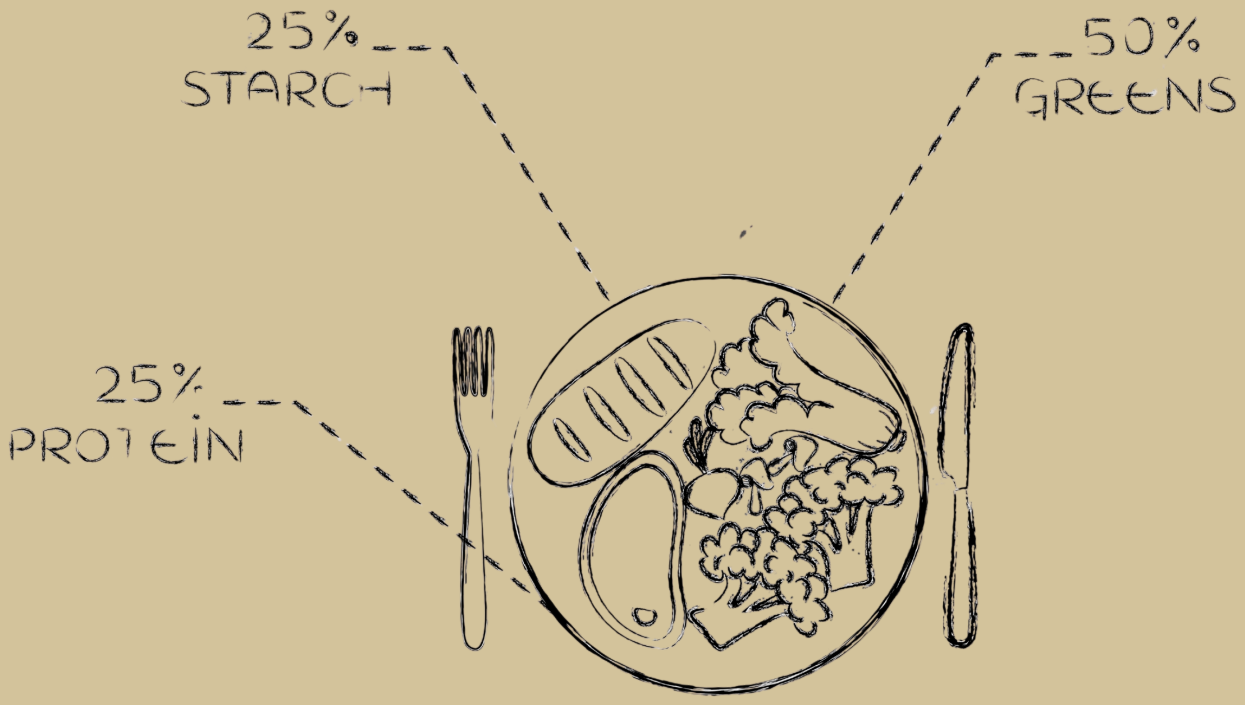
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PORTION CONTROL

MODULE

Introduction



Introduction: Why This Course Matters

Food is medicine.
It's also joy, culture, and connection.
When you cook with intention, you're not just feeding your body — you're creating a healthier, happier life.
When I faced my own diabetes diagnosis, I knew two things:
I wasn't going to eat boring, bland food... and I wasn't going to live in fear. There had to be a better way — and that's what I want to share with you.

In this course, you'll learn:

- How to build satisfying, balanced plates.
- Which ingredients nourish you (and which ones to limit).
- Cooking methods that maximize flavor and health.
- Delicious recipes that prove healthy food is anything but boring.

You'll also take quizzes to check your learning, complete a 7-Day Challenge, and proudly receive your Certificate of Completion at the end.

Let's dive in.
Your best, healthiest meals are waiting for you.

Welcome to My Kitchen

Food can be both nourishing and enjoyable. This course was created to help you understand how everyday cooking choices can support the management of blood glucose levels without sacrificing flavor, variety, or pleasure.

Throughout the course, you will learn how to build balanced plates, choose smarter carbohydrates, stock a practical pantry, and use cooking techniques that bring out natural flavor.

The goal is not perfection or unnecessary restriction. It is confidence, balance, and a flexible approach to meals you can enjoy every day.

You do not need complicated recipes or specialty ingredients to begin. With a few reliable principles and thoughtful preparation, you can create satisfying meals that fit your lifestyle and complement your personal diabetes care plan.

Let's cook with purpose, creativity, and joy.

Chef Eliane



MODULE 1

Blood Sugar & Food BasicsWhy This Course is Life-Changing

Managing diabetes begins with understanding how food affects your blood sugar levels. The goal is not to eliminate all carbohydrates but to choose wisely, combine foods properly, and maintain blood sugar stability throughout the day.

Key Concepts to Remember:

- Glycemic Index (GI):
- A system that ranks foods based on how much they raise blood sugar.
- Low-GI foods (like lentils, berries, oats) cause smaller, slower rises in blood sugar.

Macronutrients Matter:

- Carbohydrates, proteins, and fats each play a role.
- Pairing carbs with healthy fats or protein slows digestion and sugar absorption.

Fiber is Your Friend:

Fiber-rich foods (like vegetables, beans, whole grains) help keep you full longer.

Fiber slows down how fast sugar enters your bloodstream.

When you combine the right foods on your plate, you'll feel satisfied, energetic, and in control — without ever feeling deprived.

Mini Quiz – Module 1

1. What does the abbreviation GI stand for?

2. Give an example of a low-GI food.

3. Why is fiber important in managing diabetes?

📌 **Write your answers here:**

Great job!
Understanding the basics of blood sugar and food is the first step toward mastering healthy cooking for diabetes.

Now let's build a smart pantry!



MODULE 2

Smart Pantry Makeover

A smart pantry is the foundation of healthy cooking — and success starts with what you have within reach. By stocking your pantry with the right ingredients, you make it easy to whip up quick, healthy meals without temptation.

Smart Swaps for Your Pantry:

✓ White rice → Brown rice or quinoa

✓ More fiber = better blood sugar control.

✓ Regular pasta → Lentil pasta, chickpea pasta, or whole-wheat pasta

✓ Higher protein and fiber help stabilize sugars.

✓ Sugary cereal → Oatmeal (steel-cut or old-fashioned)

✓ Add cinnamon, nuts, or a few berries for a satisfying breakfast.

✓ Canned vegetables with salt → No-salt-added canned or frozen vegetables

✓ Less sodium, more flavor control.

✓ Cooking oils → Focus on olive oil, avocado oil, or coconut oil

✓ Healthier fats support heart health and insulin sensitivity

Keep a list of quick meal ingredients — canned beans, canned tuna, frozen vegetables, brown rice — so you're never stuck without a healthy option.

A well-stocked pantry removes decision fatigue — and makes success simple!

Mini Quiz – Module 2

1. Name one healthy swap for white rice.

2. What's a better choice than regular pasta?

3. Why should you choose no-salt-added canned vegetables?

📌 **Write your answers here:**

Fantastic work!
Building a smart pantry is one of the best gifts you can give yourself — and it's a powerful step toward mastering your kitchen.

Let's move on to the most exciting part: Flavor!



MODULE 3

Flavor Without Sugar

Healthy food should never taste boring!

When you learn to build flavor naturally, you unlock a world of delicious meals without relying on sugar, processed sauces, or artificial ingredients.

Flavor Builders You'll Love:

- ✓ Fresh herbs: Basil, cilantro, mint, parsley
- ✓ Spices: Cinnamon, cumin, paprika, turmeric, black pepper
- ✓ Citrus: Lemon, lime, orange zest
- ✓ Vinegars: Balsamic, red wine, apple cider vinegar
- ✓ Aromatics: Garlic, onion, ginger, leeks

When you build natural layers of flavor, you'll never even miss the sugar!

Use fresh lemon or lime to brighten up vegetables, grilled meats, and salads.

Make homemade spice blends and keep them handy to sprinkle on chicken, fish, or veggies before roasting.

Mini Quiz – Module 3

1. Name two fresh herbs you can use to boost flavor without adding sugar.

2. What ingredient can brighten up vegetables and grille dishes?

3. Why is it better to make your own seasoning blends?

📌 **Write your answers here:**

You're doing amazing!
The more you play with fresh herbs and spices, the more your meals will burst with life.
Get ready — next we dive into building the perfect balanced plate!



MODULE 4

Balanced Plates & Portion Control

Creating a balanced plate is key to managing blood sugar, feeling full, and keeping your energy steady throughout the day.

The Perfect Diabetes-Friendly Plate:

✓ Half your plate: Non-starchy vegetables (leafy greens, broccoli, peppers, zucchini)

✓ One quarter of your plate: Lean protein (chicken, fish, tofu, eggs)

✓ One quarter of your plate: Smart carbs (quinoa, brown rice, lentils, sweet potatoes)

✓ Add a little healthy fat: Olive oil drizzle, a few nuts, avocado slice

Portion Control Made Easy:

✓ Use smaller plates — it tricks your brain into feeling more satisfied.

✓ Listen to your body's hunger signals — eat slowly and mindfully.

✓ Avoid eating straight from a package — always portion onto a plate.

Balanced plates keep your meals satisfying without spikes and crashes — giving you long-lasting energy.

Mini Quiz – Module 4

1. What should take up half of your plate?

2. Give an example of a smart carbohydrate

3. Name one tip to make portion control easier.

📌 **Write your answers here:**

Wonderful progress!
You're mastering the simple, powerful habits that will make every meal a celebration of health and flavor.
Now, let's sharpen your skills even further — with healthy cooking techniques!



MODULE 5

Healthy Cooking Techniques

How you cook is just as important as what you cook!
Certain cooking methods can help you keep food flavorful, tender, and packed with nutrients — without extra sugar or unhealthy fats.

Best Cooking Techniques for Diabetes-Friendly Meals:

✓ Roasting: Brings out natural sweetness in vegetables without adding sugar.

✓ Steaming: Preserves vitamins and minerals while keeping food tender.

✓ Grilling: Adds smoky flavor without needing heavy sauces.

✓ Sautéing: Quick-cook vegetables and proteins in a little olive oil or broth.

Slow Cooking: Breaks down fibers and creates deep flavors in stews and soups.

Instead of frying, try oven-roasting or air-frying for crisp textures with a fraction of the oil!

Mastering these techniques will help you create mouthwatering meals that nourish your body and delight your taste buds.

Mini Quiz – Module 5

1. Name one healthy cooking method that brings out the sweetness in vegetables.

2. What is a great alternative to frying for a crisp texture?

3. Why is steaming a good method for cooking vegetables?

📌 **Write your answers here:**

You’re doing an incredible job!
Now that you have the knowledge, it’s time to roll up your sleeves and cook!
Let's dive into some delicious recipes next.

MODULE 6

Recipes to Savor

These three easy, diabetes-friendly recipes are packed with flavor, balanced nutrition, and simple enough to fit into your busy life.





Mediterranean Grilled Chicken Bowl

Ingredients

- 2 boneless, skinless chicken breasts
- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 2 teaspoons paprika
- 1 teaspoon cumin
- 1 lemon, juiced
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste
- 1 cup cooked quinoa or bulgur
- 1 cucumber, diced
- 1 cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ½ red onion, thinly sliced
- ¼ cup chopped fresh flat leaf parsley

Add a dollop of hummus or tzatziki for extra Mediterranean flavor!

Directions

1. In a bowl, combine olive oil, paprika, cumin, lemon juice, salt, and pepper.
2. Marinate chicken in the mixture for 30 minutes.
3. Grill or pan-cook chicken until fully cooked.
4. In a bowl, layer quinoa, cucumber, tomatoes, red onion, and sliced chicken.
5. Sprinkle with parsley and a drizzle of olive oil before serving.



Zucchini Noodles with Pesto

Ingredients

- 3 medium zucchinis (spiralized into noodles)
- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 cup fresh basil leaves
- 2 tablespoons pine nuts
- 2 cloves garlic
- 2 tablespoons grated Parmesan cheese
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste

Don't overcook the zucchini — keep it slightly crisp for the best texture!

Directions

1. Blend basil, pine nuts, garlic, Parmesan, and olive oil into a pesto sauce.
2. In a large skillet, sauté zucchini noodles briefly until just tender.
3. Toss noodles with pesto, season with salt and pepper, and serve immediately.



Berry Yogurt Parfait



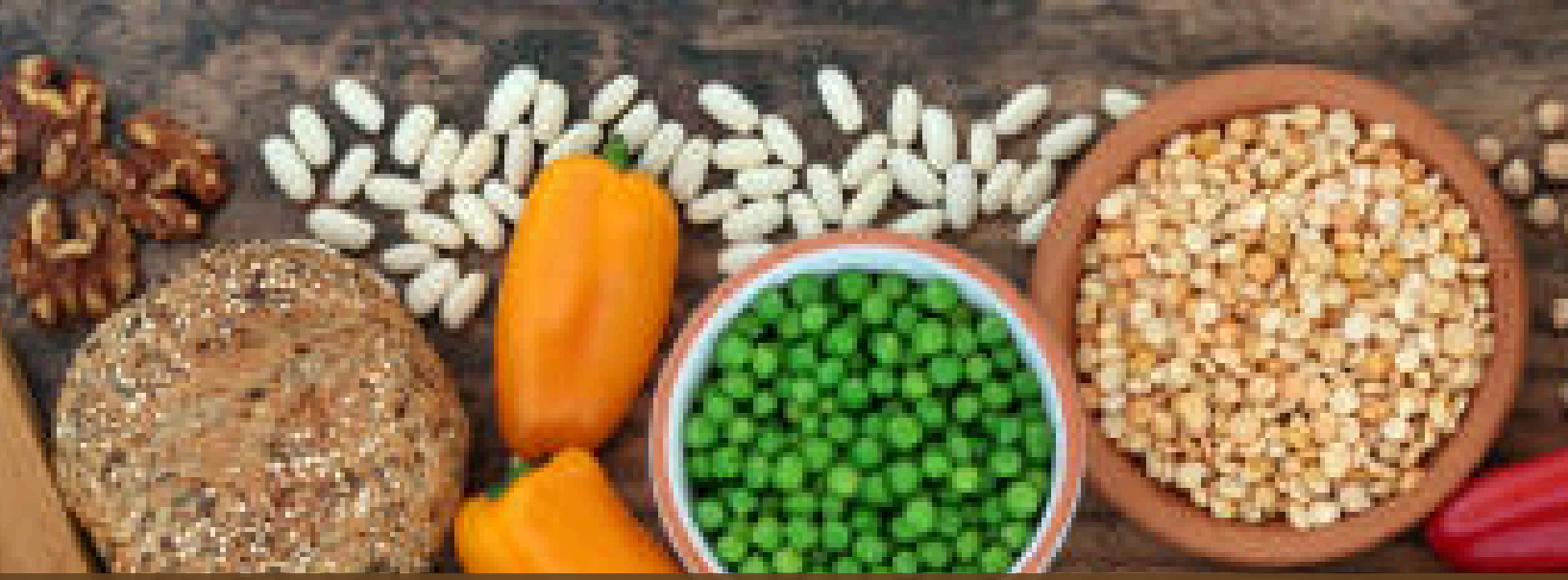
Ingredients

- 1 cup plain Greek yogurt (unsweetened)
- ½ cup mixed berries (blueberries, raspberries, strawberries)
- 1 tablespoon chia seeds
- A few chopped nuts (optional)

You can sweeten slightly with a drop of stevia if you wish — no sugar needed!

Directions

1. In a glass, layer Greek yogurt with berries and a sprinkle of chia seeds.
2. Repeat layers and top with chopped nuts if desired.
3. Enjoy immediately or refrigerate for a grab-and-go snack!



Amazing work!

You now have the building blocks to create flavorful, balanced meals for everyday life. Get ready — your 7-Day Cooking Challenge is coming next to bring everything together!





THE 7-DAY COOKING CHALLENGE

Ready to put your new skills into action?
This 7-Day Challenge is designed to make cooking easy, fun, and part of your everyday life!

Your Mission

Use the techniques and ideas you've learned.

Feel free to repeat meals or mix up new ingredient

Cook one diabetes-friendly meal each day for 7 days.



Suggested 7-Day Plan:

- Day 1: Make the Mediterranean Grilled Chicken Bowl.
- Day 2: Try a veggie-packed stir-fry with brown rice.
- Day 3: Create a colorful salad using the balanced plate method.
- Day 4: Prepare the Zucchini Noodles with Pesto.
- Day 5: Oven-roast vegetables and pair with grilled salmon.
- Day 6: Build a homemade grain bowl with quinoa and veggies.
- Day 7: Enjoy a Berry Yogurt Parfait as a fresh dessert!

Write About Your Challenge!

Use the space below to jot down what you cooked each day, how you felt, and what you discovered:

Your Notes:



FINAL QUIZ – Test Your Knowledge!

- What is the Glycemic Index?
- Why is fiber important in diabetes management?
- What is a smart carb swap for white rice?
- Name two cooking methods that are healthier than frying.
- What portion of your plate should be non-starchy vegetables?
- How does pairing carbs with protein help your blood sugar?
- Name one way to add flavor without sugar.
- What's one tip to control portions easily?

Write your answers here:_____



QUIZ & CHALLENGE ANSWERS



Mini Quiz Answers:

- GI = Glycemic Index
- Low-GI food examples: lentils, berries, oats
- Fiber slows sugar absorption and keeps you full
- Healthy swap for white rice: brown rice or quinoa
- Better pasta option: lentil pasta, chickpea pasta, or whole-wheat
- No-salt-added canned vegetables help reduce sodium intake
- Fresh herbs for flavor: basil, cilantro, mint, parsley
- Citrus brightens flavor naturally
- Homemade seasoning blends avoid hidden sugars
- Roasting brings out veggie sweetness
- Air-frying or oven-roasting gives crisp textures
- Steaming keeps vegetables nutrient-rich

Final Quiz Answers:

- GI measures how fast food raises blood sugar
- Fiber stabilizes blood sugar and improves digestion
- Smart carb swap: brown rice, quinoa
- Healthy cooking methods: roasting, steaming, grilling, sautéing
- Half your plate = non-starchy veggies
- Pairing carbs + protein = slower sugar absorption
- Flavor without sugar = use herbs, spices, citrus
- Portion control tip = smaller plates, mindful eating



CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETION INSTRUCTIONS



Congratulations! 🎉 You've finished the Diabetes Cooking Course!

You can now download your Certificate of Completion as a reminder of the skills you've built and the commitment you've made to your health.

To claim your Certificate:

Add your name to the Certificate (template provided in your course materials or Canva).
Save or print it proudly!
Celebrate this achievement — you've earned it!

Meal Planning Tips:

- Prep ingredients in batches (chop veggies, cook grains).
- Make double portions for easy lunches.
- Keep healthy snacks ready (nuts, veggie sticks, yogurt).
- Plan 3–4 dinners for the week — leave room for spontaneity.

About the Author

Chef Eliane is a classically trained chef, cookbook author, and culinary educator with a passion for making healthy cooking accessible, delicious, and fun.

After years of traveling and cooking around the world, and facing her own diabetes diagnosis, she created this course to inspire others to take control of their health through food without ever sacrificing flavor or joy.

Through Epicurean Flow, Chef Eliane shares her love of global cuisine, Mediterranean flavors, and approachable techniques that empower home cooks everywhere living with Type 2 diabetes.

Join the movement: Eat Deliciously, Live Healthfully!

Find more at: www.epicureanflow.com



Thank-you!

For being part of this journey toward healthier, more joyful cooking. I'm truly honored you chose to learn with me, and I hope this course has brought not only practical tools to your kitchen but also a renewed sense of empowerment and inspiration.

Managing diabetes doesn't mean giving up the pleasure of good food—it's about embracing smart, flavorful choices that support your well-being. As you continue cooking, don't be afraid to make each dish your own. Keep things simple, fresh, and full of love.

Final tip: Always plan a little ahead, stock your pantry with purpose, and trust your instincts—you've got this!

Don't forget to download your certificate of completion—a celebration of your dedication and progress.

For more delicious inspiration, visit the Diabetes & Nutrition page on my blog where you'll find curated recipes, tips, and helpful reads created just for you.

Warmest wishes,
Chef Eliane



Contact:

@epicureanflow

Info@epicureanflow.com

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See you in the kitchen,
Chef Eliane